

But what is disappointing is the fact that the webcam can only shoot images in 720p. It seems like something that Dell accidentally forgot about because even budget laptops in 2023 come equipped with at least a 1080p webcam. And in the premium segment brands like HP have taken up the lead by giving you a 5MP AI-focused webcam.

BATTERY LIFE AND CHARGING

In the PC Mark 10 battery life test, the Dell XPS 17 scored 8.5 hours of battery life with performance set to high and brightness at 100%. For a normal

70W TGP limit. But that doesn't mean that it can't play games. I tested some popular titles like Shadow of the Tomb Raider, and Gears 5 at 4k native resolution and the laptop was easily able to run it at 60FPS.

Now, the Dell XPS 17 also has a feature that dynamically controls power and cooling depending on whether you're using the laptop on your lap or on the desk. And that feature works mostly, but if you're gaming on the XPS 17 then the laptop's underside gets quite hot. Hot enough that you can no longer keep it on your lap anymore. But not hot

tions if you're buying this machine by thinking it is a creator/gaming laptop. Because in truth, it is the only creator laptop that can be used for some casual gaming. I want to also tell you that the laptop scored a fantastic score in the PC Mark 10 Extended benchmark suite. Individually scoring very high in digital content creation and productivity. Moreover, the 1TB SSD onboard also aced the Crystal Disk Mark Speed test. Achieving a super high score of 6783.40MB/s and 5613.91MB/s read and write speed respectively.

VERDICT

Suffice it to say, the Dell XPS 17 works as a gaming laptop but performs really well as a productivity machine. And with a tested battery life of around 8.5 hours with 100% screen brightness, this hefty machine makes up for its weight with solid performance. Its UHD+ 4K display is bright and crisp enough for me to not wish for an OLED and its no bezel design combined with the 16:10 aspect ratio works tremendously in the laptop's favour. The best-in-class speakers also work as a cherry on top of an already capable machine. But its ageing design does limit the potential the laptop's hardware is packing. For Rs 3.65 lakh, the Dell XPS 17 is inoffensive when it should be an aggressive performer. But if you're looking for a good 'ol reliable Windows machine with software quirks and average thermal performance then Dell XPS 17 is a good choice.

—Yetnesh Dubey



Gangsta Granny's thoughts

"Yo, check out the Dell XPS 17 droppin' some tech knowledge! It might be old school in design, but it's packin' a punch with that 4K screen and those dope speakers. Just wish it had a better webcam, ya feel me?"

workday, the Dell XPS 17 will last you a full day provided you keep the brightness at 70% and performance in balanced mode. Normal browsing does not consume a lot of battery but streaming videos does start to eat a good chunk of it. And considering the overall powerful nature of the laptop, I'd advise you to keep the charger within reach especially if you plan on using it while traveling.

GAMING AND PERFORMANCE

The Dell XPS 17 is not a gaming laptop, its main focus, first and foremost, is as a creator machine. But you can still expect good gaming performance from it. Along with the Intel Core i9-13900H is an Nvidia RTX 4070 which has 8GB GDDR6 VRAM. But the GPU only has a

enough that it'd start making hot spots on the keyboard.

I extensively played games on the Dell XPS 17 and the only area which gets marginally hot is the mid-keyboard section. The palm rest area and the WASD keys remain decently cool. But the fact is that the laptop's performance drops a decent bit if you push too hard. As evident by the Cinebench R23 throttle test, the Core i9-13900H loses noticeable performance when put through a 10-minute throttle run.

Moreover, during extended gameplay, the laptop did run into some software bugs. Which quite often forced me to restart it. And it only happened while gaming so it could be due to the GPU. Nevertheless, temper your expecta-

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: 13th Gen Intel® Core™ i9-13900H (24 MB cache, 14 cores, up to 5.40 GHz Turbo) | Operating System: Windows 11 Home Single Language, English | Video Card: NVIDIA® GeForce RTX™ 4070, 8 GB GDDR6 | Display: 17", UHD+ 3840x2400, 60Hz, Touch, Anti-Reflect, 500 nit, InfinityEdge | Memory: 32 GB: 2 x 16 GB, DDR5, 4800 MT/s | Storage: 1 TB, M.2, PCIe NVMe, SSD | Colour: Platinum Silver exterior, Black interior | Camera: 720p at 30 fps, HD RGB + IR camera | Digital-array microphones

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